

Design system

Everything in here is lifted from the live Lost Job Report, not written from memory. Same tokens, same components, same rules. This document is set in them, so it doubles as a specimen.

What this covers

The report landing page and the scanner at matviykorsunskiy.me/dialbridge-report. Colour, type, spacing and components are pages two and three. The part worth reading twice is page four, the interaction rules, and page five, the things that broke.

The short version

01 One warm neutral ground, one orange

The page sits on off-white paper, not white. Orange appears only on things you can act on. Green, amber and red mean a judgement about the business, never decoration.

02 One typeface, fluid sizes

Plus Jakarta Sans throughout, weights 400 to 800. Headings use clamp so they shrink on a phone without a media query.

03 Cards are white on paper, radius 14

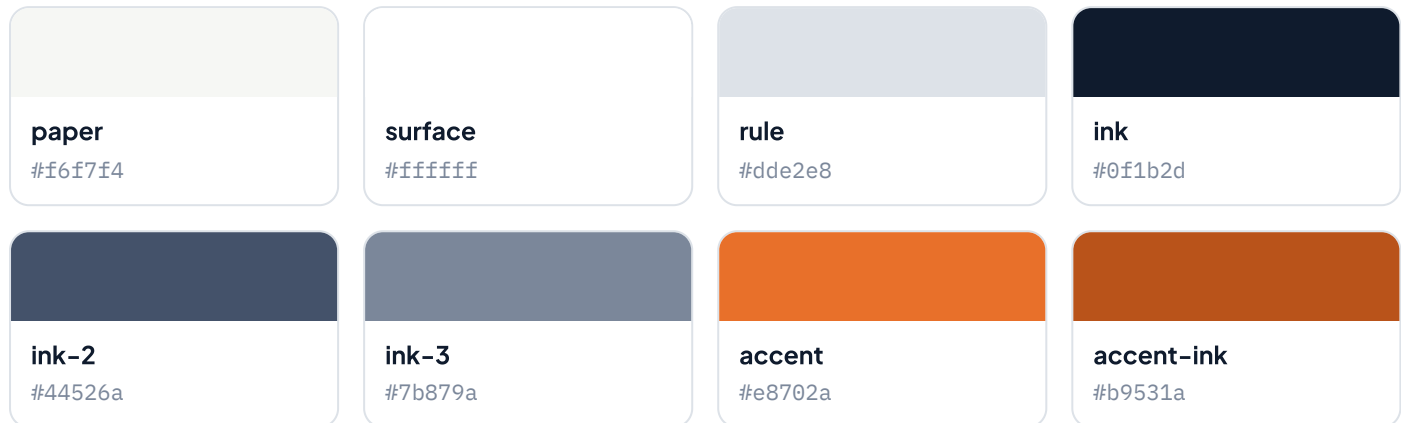
One card style, one radius, one shadow. Depth comes from the paper-to-white contrast, not from stacking shadows.

04 Built phone-first, tested on a laptop

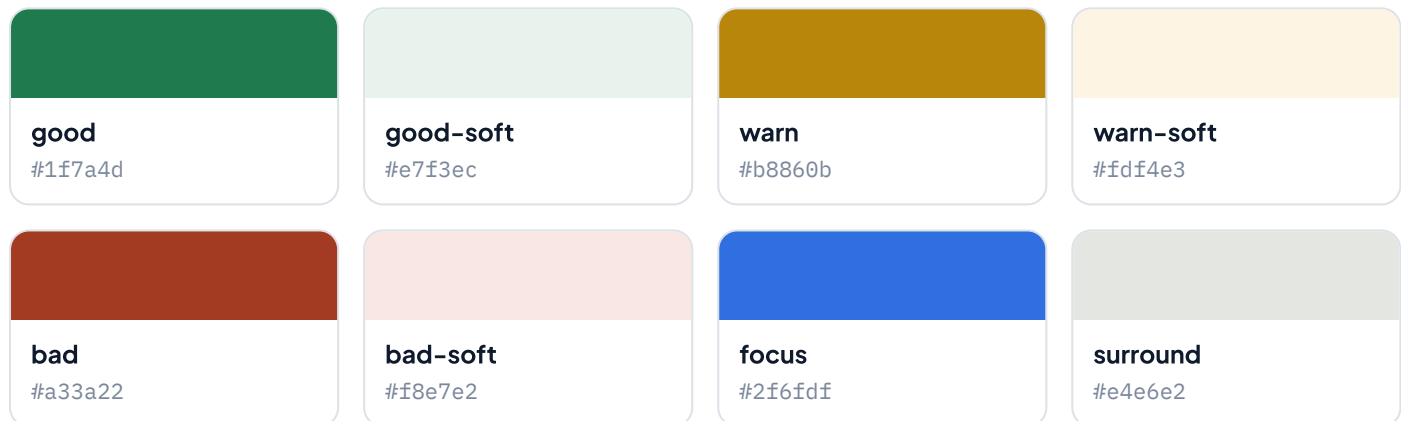
Contractors read this on a phone in a van. Every layout decision was checked at 390px before it was checked at 1280.

Colour

Surface and ink



Judgement, and the soft fill each one sits on



The one colour rule

Orange is **action**. Green, amber and red are **verdicts about the business**. Never let a verdict colour a button, and never let orange imply something is good or bad. The moment those mix, a red card reads as a thing to click.

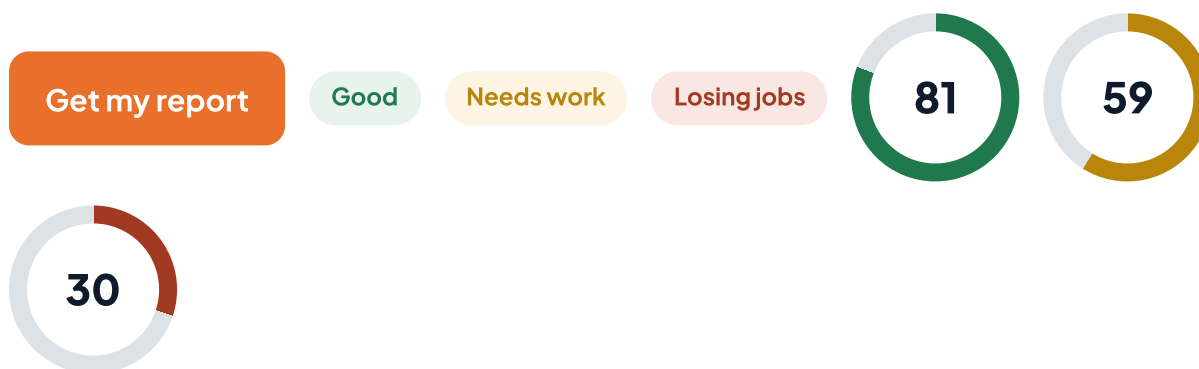
```
:root {
  --ink: #0f1b2d;    --ink-2: #44526a;    --ink-3: #7b879a;
  --paper: #f6f7f4;  --surface: #ffffff;  --rule: #dde2e8;
  --accent: #e8702a;  --accent-ink: #b9531a;  --focus: #2f6fdf;
  --good: #1f7a4d;   --warn: #b8860b;    --bad: #a33a22;
  --radius: 14px;
  --shadow: 0 1px 2px rgba(15,27,45,.06), 0 12px 32px rgba(15,27,45,.08);
}
```

Type, shape and components

Plus Jakarta Sans, 400 to 800. Headings clamp so they fit a phone without a breakpoint.

hero	clamp(2.1rem, 6vw, 3.6rem)
section h2	clamp(1.35rem, 3.4vw, 1.9rem)
card h3	clamp(1.15rem, 2.8vw, 1.45rem)
body	0.95rem on a 16px root, line-height 1.55
label / eyebrow	0.66REM MONO, 0.16EM TRACKING, UPPERCASE

Components



The score ring is a conic-gradient on a circle with a surface-coloured hole punched by `::after`. No SVG, no library.

```
.card { background: var(--surface); border: 1px solid var(--rule);
  border-radius: var(--radius); padding: 22px 24px; }

.cta { border: 0; border-radius: 10px; padding: 12px 18px;
  background: var(--accent); color: #fff; font-weight: 700; }

.ring { --tone: var(--warn);
  background: conic-gradient(var(--tone) calc(var(--pct) * 1%), var(--rule) 0);
  border-radius: 50%; display: grid; place-items: center; }
.ring::after { content: ""; position: absolute; inset: 9px;
  border-radius: 50%; background: var(--surface); }
.ring.tone-good { --tone: var(--good); }
.ring.tone-bad { --tone: var(--bad); }
```

Interaction rules

These are the decisions that made the scanner work, and they transfer to the new site more usefully than any hex value.

01 One question per screen

Four questions, four taps, one idea each, no scrolling and no form. A contractor answers it at a red light. A single page with four fields would not get finished.

02 Earn the wait, do not hide it

The scan shows seven named steps completing in real time, because it really is calling Google seven ways. Showing the work is what makes the result feel measured rather than generated. A spinner would have wasted the same thirty seconds and bought nothing.

03 Give the proof away, gate the explanation

The two scores are free and visible. Everything under them is blurred, not hidden. The blur is the point: it proves there is something there, which is what makes a phone number feel worth giving.

04 Never show a number you cannot defend

When Google cannot return a service-area business, the page explains why instead of drawing nine "not found" pins. A confident wrong answer costs more trust than an honest gap.

05 Their words, not ours

"Your Google Maps position when someone searched plumber", not "SERP grid ranking". And money is always a monthly figure. Never ask the reader to do arithmetic to feel the point.

06 The logo goes home

Small thing, constantly got wrong. The brand mark is a real button that resets the scan, with a visible back control beside it for anyone who does not think to try the logo.

Focus is visible, always

Every interactive element gets `outline: 3px solid var(--focus); outline-offset: 3px` on `:focus-visible`. Never remove an outline without replacing it with something equally obvious.

Six things that broke

Each of these cost real debugging time on the report. None are obvious.

1. [hidden] loses to any display rule

A element marked `hidden` stayed on screen because a class set `display: grid`. Put `[hidden]{display: none !important;}` in the reset and never think about it again.

2. minmax(430px, 1fr) does not shrink

A card grid using `minmax(430px, 1fr)` pushed the whole report off every phone, because minmax will not go below its floor. Use `minmax(min(430px, 100%), 1fr)`.

3. text-wrap: balance leaves short lines

Balance evens line lengths, which looks deliberate on a big centred headline and looks like wasted space on a left-aligned heading in a card. Those were using 58 to 69 percent of the width. `text-wrap: pretty` fills the line and only prevents a one-word last line.

4. A custom property set once never changes

The score rings never changed colour. `.ring{--tone: var(--warn)}` was set, and the `.tone-good` and `.tone-bad` classes existed but nothing ever redefined the variable. Declaring a token is not the same as reading it.

5. A centred modal covers the thing it is selling

The unlock dialog sat over the two scores on a 1366 by 768 laptop, which left nothing to unlock for. It became a bottom sheet under 820px of height, with no dark scrim, so the scores stay readable behind it.

6. Safari and Firefox trim the referrer

Both send only the origin on cross-origin requests, so a Google Maps key restricted to a subpath returns 403 on every iPhone. `meta.referrer` and `referrerPolicy` are both ignored. The key restriction has to include the bare origin with a wildcard.

Checklist

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- ☐ Copy the **token block** from page two verbatim. Do not re-pick the orange.
 - ☐ Load **Plus Jakarta Sans** 400 to 800 with a real fallback stack, and use it for everything.
 - ☐ **One card style, one radius, one shadow.** If a second card style appears, one of them is wrong.
 - ☐ Headings on **clamp**, body on rem. No fixed pixel type outside labels.
 - ☐ **Orange only on actions.** Green, amber and red only on verdicts.
 - ☐ Design at **390px first**, then check 1280. Not the other way round.
 - ☐ Visible **:focus-visible** outline on every interactive element.
 - ☐ Every grid minmax uses **min(px, 100%)** as its floor.
 - ☐ Put **[hidden] { display: none !important }** in the reset.
 - ☐ The **logo goes home**, and there is a second visible way back.
 - ☐ Any Google Maps key is restricted to the **bare origin with a wildcard**, or half your mobile traffic gets a 403.
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If in doubt

The report works because it shows its working and refuses to claim anything it has not measured. Carry that across and the visual details matter much less than they look like they do.